

United

Narrator: This is a story that has been retold several times by historians and can be found in almost every history book that you come across. But let me tell you the more internal affairs and events that led to the most groundbreaking and the most memorable revolution that ever occurred in the world still. In a world of cruel nobles and aristocrats, an abominable clergy, five rather innocent people find themselves locked in a cellar not more than five by five feet. However, the events that led to these people getting them landed in this adverse situation are not nearly as interesting as how they made their escape. But when I say ‘adverse’ for them, it is not so much because of how they were so cruelly imprisoned by the king, but more so because of the kind of people they were imprisoned with. One of the five is a priest, one is a nobleman, one is a lawyer, one is a doctor, and the last is a homeless labourer. These unfortunate five are seated as far away from each other as was possible in this tiny cellar.

The Nobleman: Ooooooooooh! I am so hungry. Why won’t anyone bring me some food! Hey You! Doctor! Go bring me the highest quality of bread that you can find along with some rich potatoes and a juicy pineapple squash. I have never gone so long without eating anything.

Doctor (Disgustedly): Food! Here! Well I suppose someone has been a little too pampered! Anyways, just look at your belly. How do you even manage to stuff so much down your throat to get it to be of that size?

Priest: This is a disaster! This is the end. The holy presence of a priest has been polluted by such dirty filth as the lawyer, the doctor, and the labourer. Forgive me my Lord! I have brought disgrace upon you. I know that my sin is unforgivable, yet forgive me. Know, that I was forced into this situation. Forgive me and punish him who committed this sacrilege and put the priest at the same level as the labourer.

Lawyer (arguing): Hey! Your “Lord” can’t help us at this time, can he? So, for your God’s sake, stop your prayers and LET. ME. THINK.

Priest: HOW DARE YOU INSULT THE LORD! You have co.....

Labourer: Stop it you four! You sound like a bunch of small children fighting over a candy!

Nobleman: I will NOT be spoken to like that.

Labourer (with forced calm): Okay Okay! Now alright. I got a plan. First, we need to get rid of this guard watching us. You! Nobleman! Act like you have run out of cigars. Persuade him to bring you some. I know that you are the best at complaining out of us five.

Nobleman: I WILL NOT-

Priest: This is the end of our society! A nobleman is being commanded by a labourer. May God strike down this impudent woman with all His ultimate might into the deepest chasms of Hell.

Labourer: Please! Please! I beg of you!

Nobleman (grumbling): Oh Alright!

Nobleman: Hey there! You! Yes you! I want some cigar! No, I won't hear nothing before you get me a cigar. Look! Look! I am dying! I need one right now.

Narrator: The labourer's plan works effortlessly. With the Watchguard gone, she takes out a hairpin from her hair, and after a few tries, opens the lock of the cellar.

Labourer: Now come! COME!

Narrator: The nobleman and the priest grumble, not ready to take orders from a labourer.

Labourer: You wish to rot here in the cellar? Fine! Doctor, Lawyer, let us get outta here.

Narrator: The Labourer, the Doctor and the Lawyer make their move. The nobleman and the priest are left behind. But for how long can one stay oblivious to one's fault? One *has* to accept one's wrong one day. When the three are out of sight, the nobleman sneaks out and silently walks away on the same path the other three. The priest looks at him disgustedly, but himself is out of the cellar soon after the nobleman. In this singular fashion they go around the prison; the Labourer, the Doctor and the Lawyer in the lead, the nobleman walking at the same pace some distance back, and the priest bringing up the rear.

Narrator: Now we go back to the nobleman. He has walked some distance now, keeping on the same track as the labourer. As he reaches the end of the corridor, he finds the labourer, the doctor, the lawyer caught and tied up in ropes by the watch guards. The exit door is just behind them and its key is held by one of the guards. What can he do? Fighting the guards would be synonymous with helping the labourer, the doctor and the lawyer. But at the same time, there is no other means of escape. So, the nobleman decisively turns towards the guards. With all the force that his corpulent body can muster, he plunges at them.

Narrator: An epic fight ensues. The Labourer, the doctor and the Lawyer also break free from the ropes. More guards arrive. The prisoners are easily outnumbered by the huge numbers of guards. There is little hope of victory when suddenly the Lawyer snatches the key to the exit from the guard who held it. Keeping it as high up in the air as possible, he tries to reach the exit, but alas, the guards are just too many.

Narrator: Afraid of losing the key to the guards again, he throws it high up in the air as far as possible from the guards. It soars through the air, as if in slow motion, in a graceful parabola. The eyes of the four revolutionaries follow its path.

All four (gasping in slow motion): Wwwwwoooooahhhh!

Narrator: As the key flies forward it finds a pair of hands which belong to none other than the Priest. Walking behind the Nobleman, he too had caught up with the ensuing fight. Now with the key in his hands, he sees an opportunity to sneak unnoticed through the guards and out of the exit. Filled with madness at the prospect of escaping the prison, he rushes out.

Lawyer: Look! He's escaping.

Doctor: Run! Run!

Lawyer: Nooo! There are just too many guards.

Labourer: He betrayed us! The Priest betrayed us! That scoundrel!

Narrator: Some of the guards try to chase the priest, but the priest is nowhere to be seen. Meanwhile, the situation quickly worsens for the other four, as the guards again manage to strap them down securely in stronger ropes.

Narrator: All hope is lost for the labourer, the lawyer, the doctor and the nobleman. They are filled with a deadly despair, when they hear a distant roar, like the foreboding of a thunderstorm. As if in no time, thousands of villagers are upon the guards, thundering into the jail, murdering the guards and breaking the walls. Amidst these stands the Priest.

Priest: Kill them all! Kill them all! Free the prisoners! Go go, my militia!

Narrator: As the rest of the prisoners join the Priest...

Doctor: You brought help!

Priest (smiling): Yes, I did. Having a hard time believing that, are you?

Narrator: Such were the incidents of the night of 14 July 1789 that sparked the feeling of nationalism in the hearts of every French person. Historians may tell you about this incident as the 'Storming of the Bastille', but only those five prisoners know the least detail of what had really happened there that night.

THANK YOU

- Manan Garg
X-B